

Session Eight

Attitudes and job satisfaction

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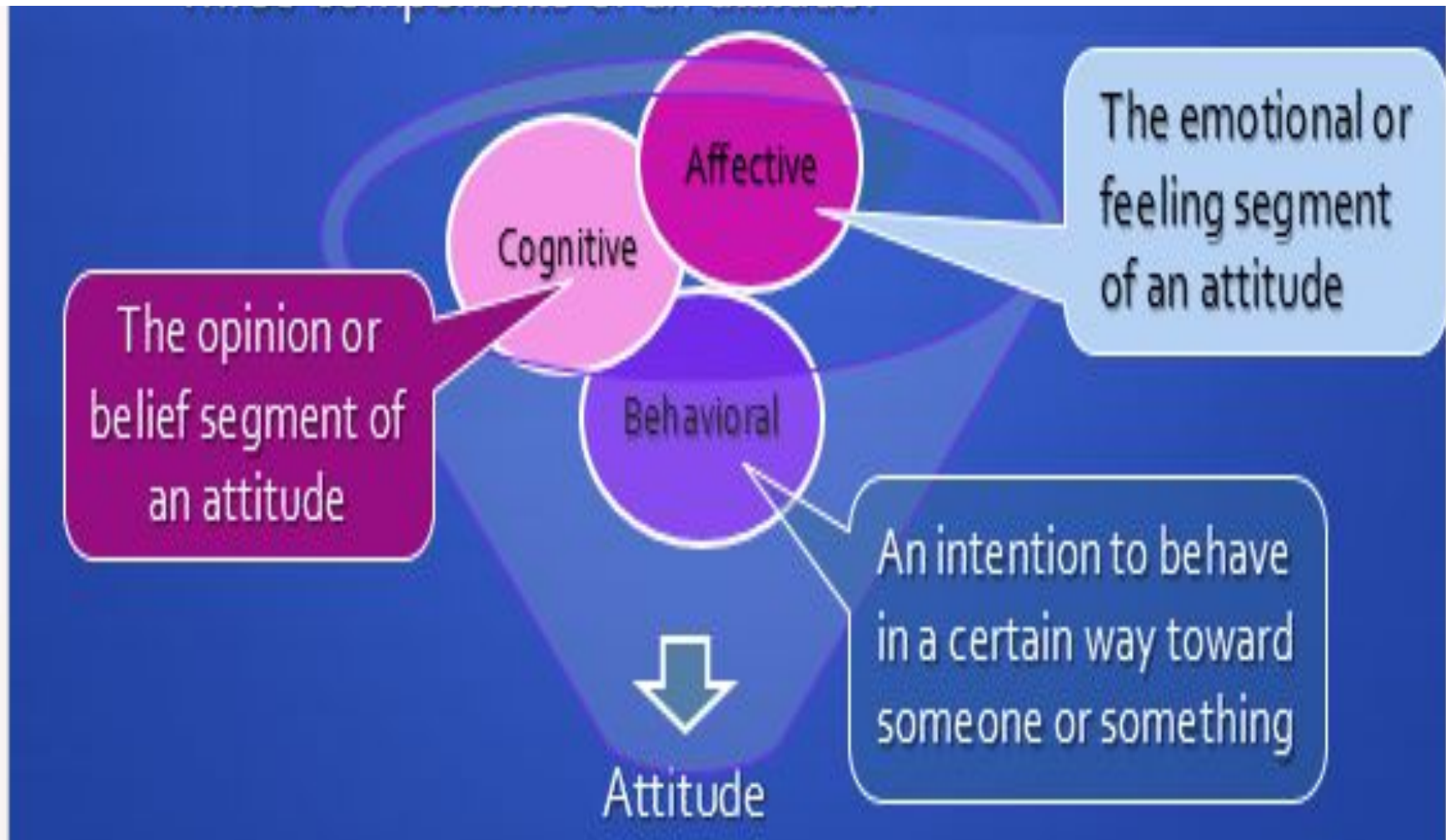
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Attitude !!!!!

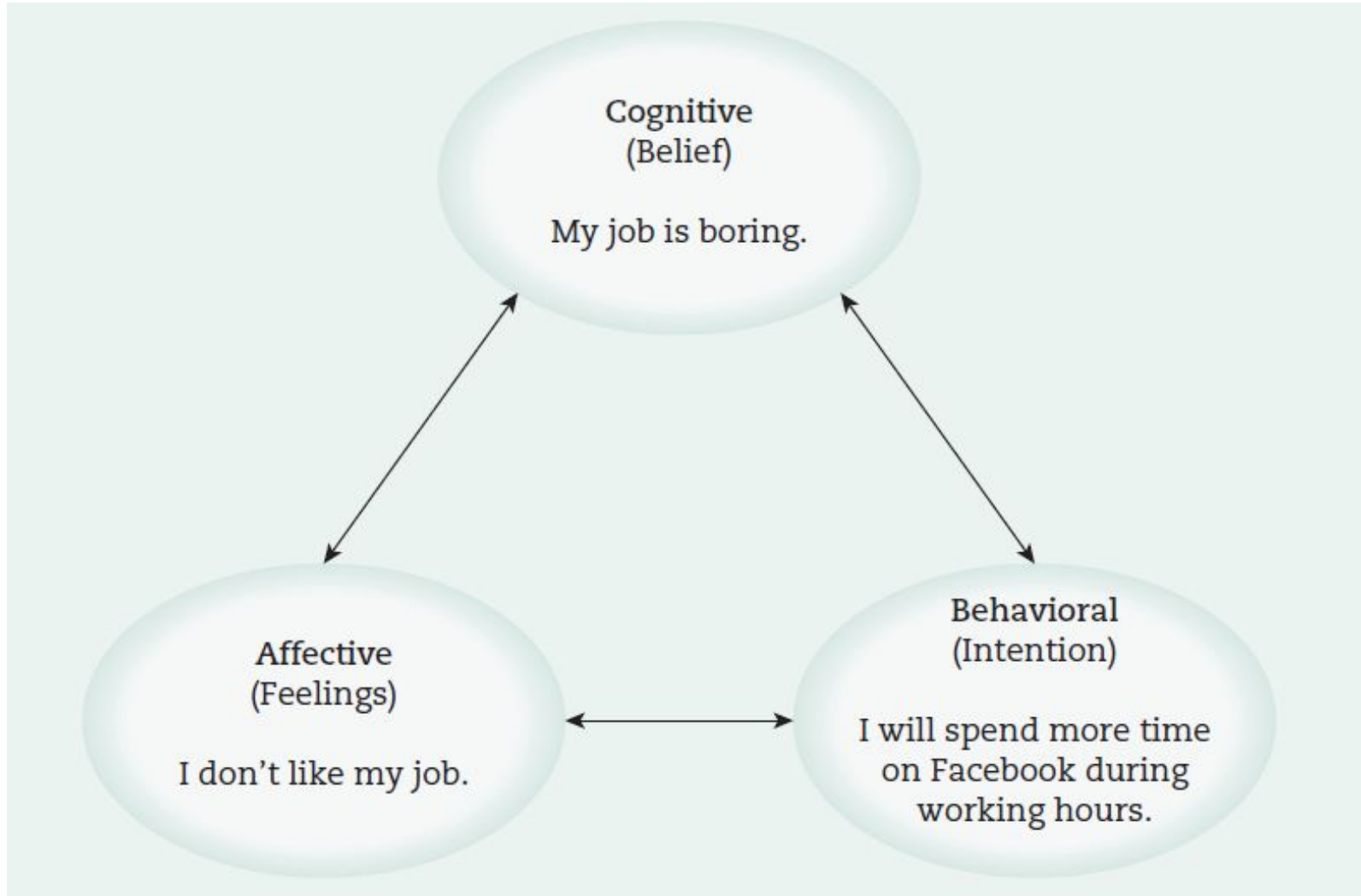
Attitudes are evaluative statements or judgments concerning *objects, people, or events*. Typically, attitudes are *favorable or unfavorable: positive or negative* (Eagly & Chaiken, 1993)

Attitude has components: an **affective component** (feelings), a **behavioral component** (the effect of the attitude on behavior), and a **cognitive component** (belief and knowledge) (Rosenberg & Hovland, 1960).

General perceptions of the components of attitude

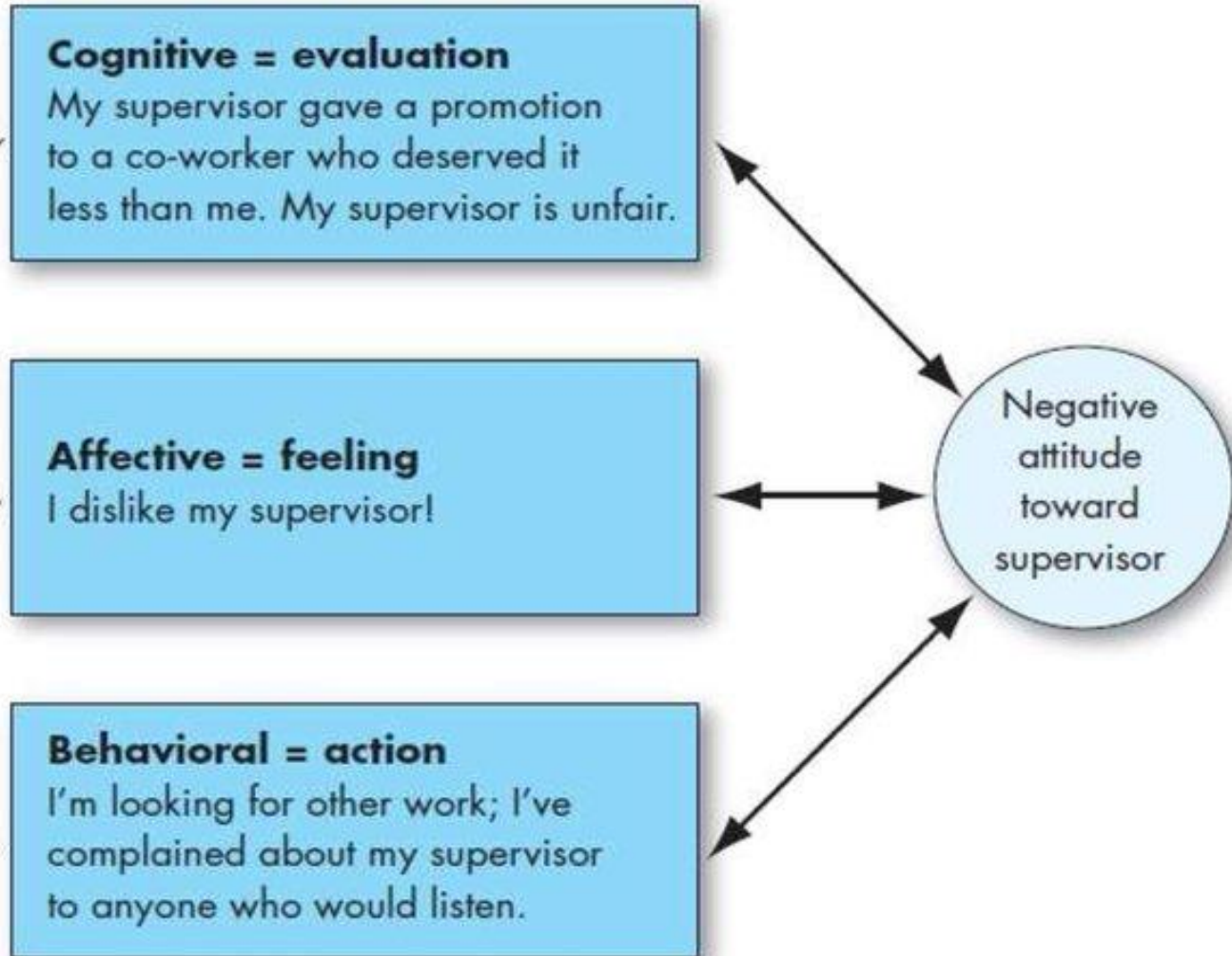


In terms of an object



In terms of people and event

Cognition, affect, and behavior are closely related.



Relationship between attitude and behaviour!!!!!!

Attitude & Behavior

- Attitude ----- Behavior
- Behavior ----- Attitude
- Which relationship is true?
- Festinger argues in favor of the second relationship.
- Is there any absolute truth in OB?

Relationship between attitude and behaviour!!!!!!

Attitude and behaviour is positively correlated.

A sizable number of studies have examined the relationship between attitudes and behavior (e.g., Eagly & Chaiken, 1993; Kraus, 1995; Oskamp & Schultz, 2005).

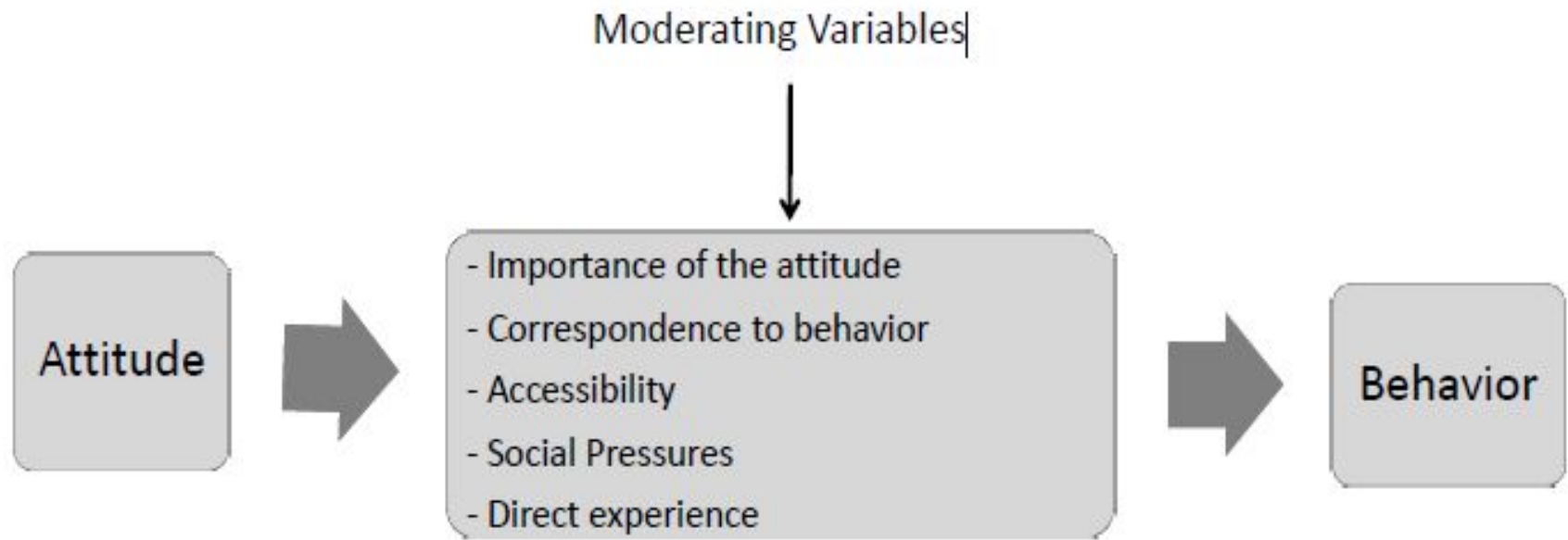
But, sometimes, this finding is incompatible.

The term ***cognitive dissonance*** is used to describe the **mental discomfort** that results from holding **two conflicting beliefs**, values, or attitudes.

An example of cognitive dissonance



Attitude-Behavior Model



Job attitudes !!!!

We have thousands of attitudes, but OB focuses on a very limited number.

Much of the research has looked at three attitudes:

**Job satisfaction,
Job involvement,
Organizational commitment.**

Job satisfaction

Job satisfaction: a positive feeling about a job resulting from an evaluation of its characteristics. A person with high job satisfaction holds *positive feelings* about the work, while a person with low satisfaction holds *negative feelings*.

Causes of job satisfaction

- **Need Fulfillment:** Satisfaction is based on the extent to which a job satisfies a person's needs.
- **Discrepancies:** Satisfaction is determined by the extent to which an individual receives what he or she expects from a job.
- **Value Attainment:** Satisfaction results from the extent to which a job allows fulfillment of one's work values.
- **Equity:** Satisfaction is a function of how “fairly” an individual is treated at work.

Outcomes of job satisfaction

Outcomes of job satisfaction

- Improving productivity
 - Decreased turnover
 - Improve attendance
 - Reduce accidents
 - Less job stress
- Organizational Citizenship Behavior (OCB)

The discretionary **behavior that is not part of an employee's formal job requirements**, and that contributes to the psychological and social environment of the workplace, is called organizational citizenship behavior.

Approaches to measure job satisfaction

Two approaches are popular.

The single global rating: Just ask one question i.e considering all things, how satisfied are you with your job?

Likert scale: Respondents circle a number between 1 and 5 on a scale from “highly satisfied” to “highly dissatisfied.”

- ***Which approach is better?***

Attention to context may help in choosing which approach is appropriate for what situation.

The second method, the summation of job facets, is more sophisticated and accepted (**Likert**)

Approaches to measure job satisfaction

A. Sample items from the Minnesota Satisfaction Questionnaire

Employees respond to each of the items by checking whether they are:

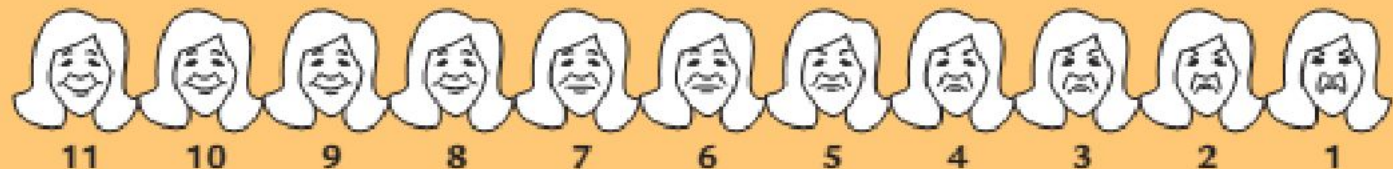
- ☐ Very dissatisfied
- ☐ Dissatisfied
- ☐ Can't decide whether satisfied or not
- ☐ Satisfied
- ☐ Very satisfied

On my present job, this is how I feel about . . .

1. Being able to keep busy all the time.
2. The chance to be "somebody" in the community.
3. The way my job provides for steady employment.
4. My pay and the amount of work I do.
5. The freedom to use my own judgment.
6. The chance to work by myself.
7. The chance to develop close friendships with my co-workers.
8. The way I get full credit for the work I do.
9. The chance to help people.
10. My job security.

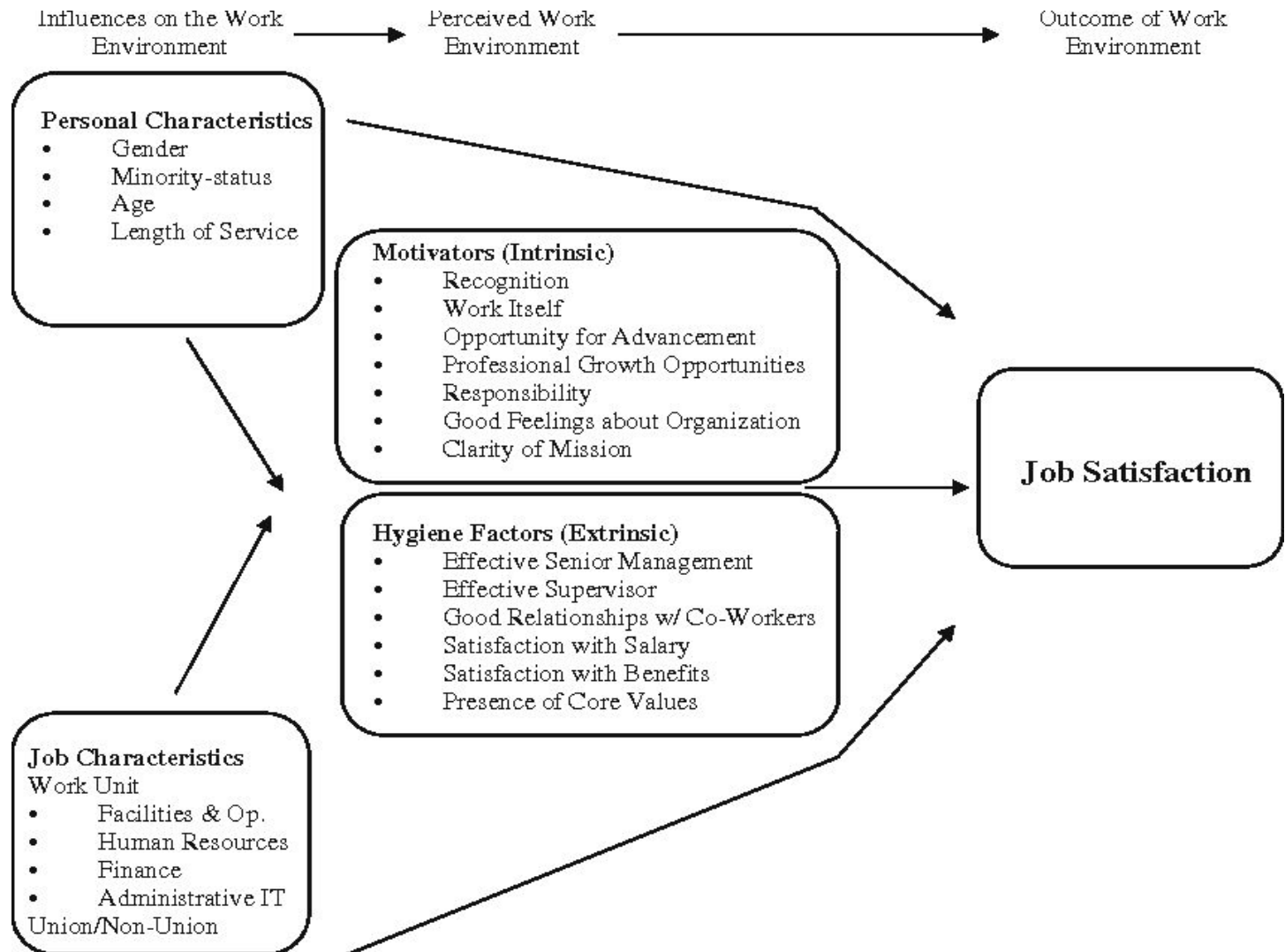
B. The Faces Scale

Employees select the face that best expresses how they feel about their job in general.



Source: (A) D. J. Weiss et al., Manual for the Minnesota Satisfaction Questionnaire, 1967. Minnesota Studies in Vocational Rehabilitation:

Components of job satisfaction with theory



Impact of job dissatisfaction

The *exit response* directs behavior toward leaving the organization, including looking for a new position or resigning.

The *voice response* includes actively and constructively attempting to improve conditions, including suggesting improvements.

The *loyalty response* means passively but optimistically waiting for conditions to improve, including speaking up for the organization in the face of external criticism and trusting the organization and its management to “do the right thing.”

The *neglect response* passively allows conditions to worsen and includes chronic absenteeism or lateness, reduced effort, and an increased error rate.

	Constructive	Destructive
Active	VOICE	EXIT
Passive	LOYALTY	NEGLECT

Job involvement

Job involvement refers to a state of psychological identification with work—or the degree to which a job is vital to a person's identity.

Job involvement is the **degree to which an employee identifies with his or her job**, actively participates in it, and considers his or her job performance to be important to his or her self-worth. Employees with a high level of this involvement strongly identify with and really care about the kind of work they do.

Outcomes of job involvement

- Increased employee productivity (Jones, Kalmi, & Kauhanen, 2010)
- Improved organizational decision-making capability (Apostolou, 2000)
- Improved attitude regarding work (Leana, Ahlbrandt, & Murrell, 1992)
- Substantially improved employee well-being (Freeman & Kleiner, 2005)

Organizational commitment

Organizational commitment is the individual's **mental connection to the organization.**



Examples

Staying
because
you
want to



PSYNERGY
My job is
rewarding and
I enjoy coming
to work each
day

Staying
because
you
need to



My salary and
benefits get me
a nice house in
a nice area

Staying
because
you
ought to



My boss has
invested so
much time in
training and
mentoring me

Relationship among the research variables with job satisfaction

Variables Related with Satisfaction	Direction of Relationship	Strength of Relationship
<i>Motivation</i>	Positive	Moderate
<i>Job Involvement</i>	Positive	Moderate
<i>Organizational Citizenship behavior</i>	Positive	Moderate
<i>Organizational Commitment</i>	Positive	Strong
<i>Absenteeism</i>	Negative	Weak
<i>Turnover</i>	Negative	Moderate
<i>Heart Disease</i>	Negative	Moderate
<i>Perceived Stress</i>	Negative	Strong
<i>Job Performance</i>	Positive	Weak
<i>Life Satisfaction</i>	Positive	Moderate
<i>Mental Health</i>	Positive	Moderate